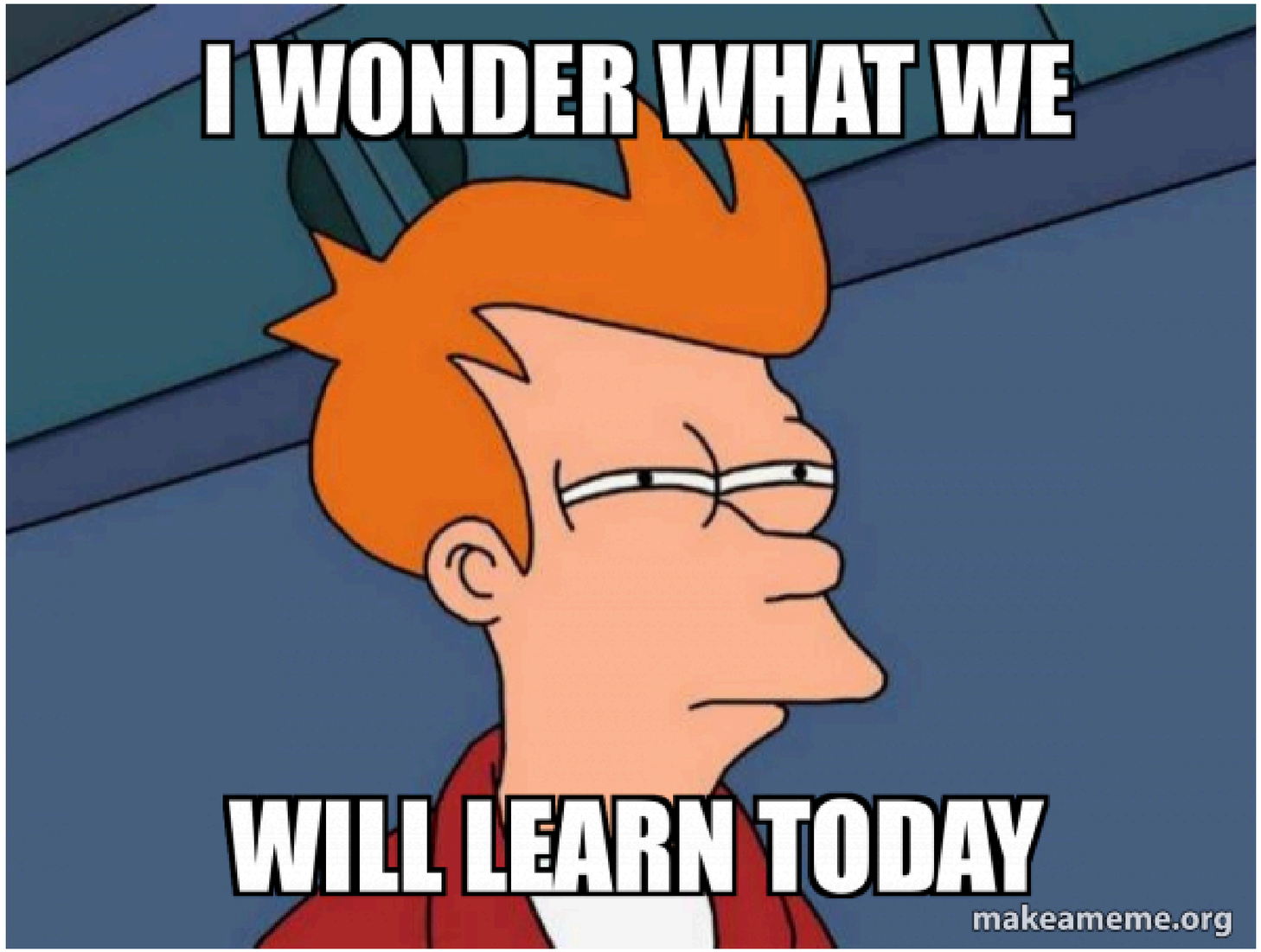
User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics



User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics

What are we going to learn today?

Agenda

- Definition of user story
- Their role in agile development
- User roles/personas
- Good/bad examples

User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics

What are user stories?

A user story is a short, user-centered requirement description that expresses **role**, **activity**, and **business value**, and serves as the foundation for agile planning and development.

User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics



Manifesto for Agile Software Development

We are uncovering better ways of developing
software by doing it and helping others do it.
Through this work we have come to value:

Individuals and interactions over processes and tools

Working software over comprehensive documentation

Customer collaboration over contract negotiation

Responding to change over following a plan

That is, while there is value in the items on
the right, we value the items on the left more.

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A little bit of psychology

Narrative cognition is the way humans naturally understand and remember information through stories, seeing events as sequences involving **characters**, **goals**, and **outcomes**. This makes information more engaging, meaningful, and easier to remember .

https://www.braininsights.net/the-power-of-stories-unraveling-the-psychology-behind-their-resilience-and-healing/

User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics

How Does This Relate to the User Story?

User stories leverage this by presenting requirements from the perspective of the user, including their goals and the value they seek. This approach helps not only developers, but also product owners, testers, designers, and stakeholders to understand the context, empathize with the user, and make informed decisions.

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How Does This Relate to the User Story?

For example, a story like “As a shopper, I want to quickly search for products so that I can find what I need” communicates the user’s goal and value clearly, making it easier for the entire team to align on priorities and design choices.



User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics

Why Roles and Personas Matter

- Touch some grass :)
- Empathy → helps developers understand who they’re building for
- Ensure priorities reflect actual user needs



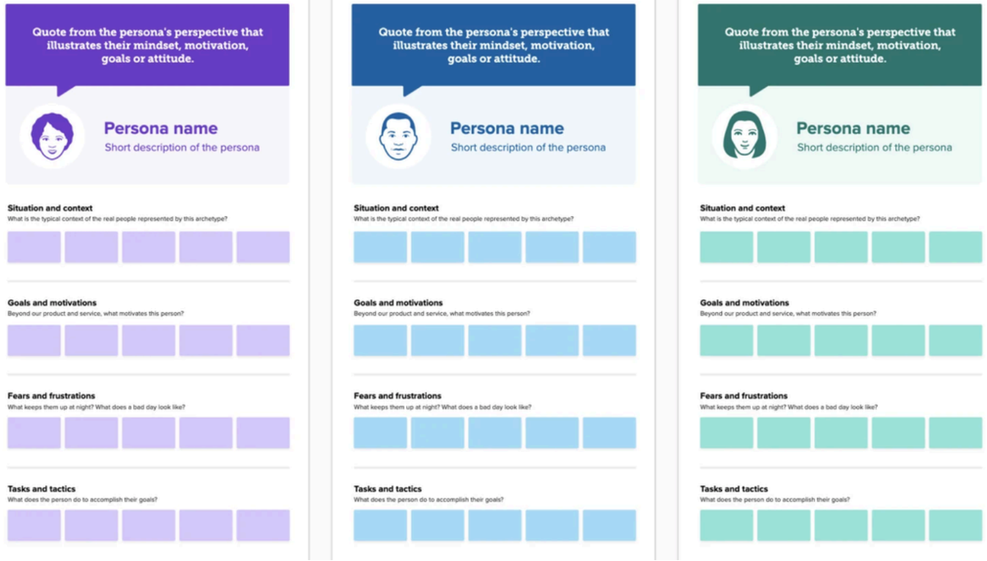
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Anatomy of a Persona

A persona typically includes:

- Role / Job function (e.g., “Online Shopper,” “Admin User”)
- Demographics (age, background, context of use)
- Goals
- Pain points :(

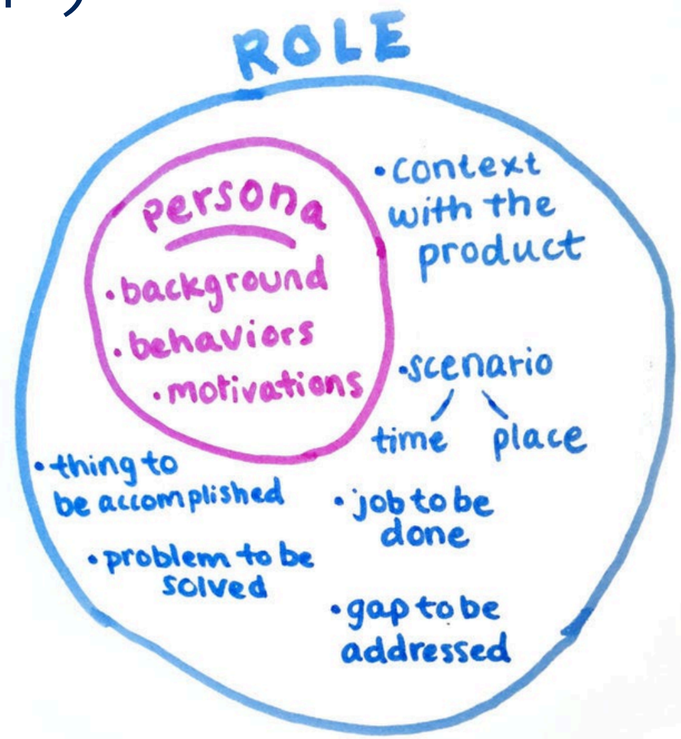




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Roles vs. Personas

Generic function (e.g., “Admin,” “Customer”)



Fictional, but realistic story of a user that represents a role

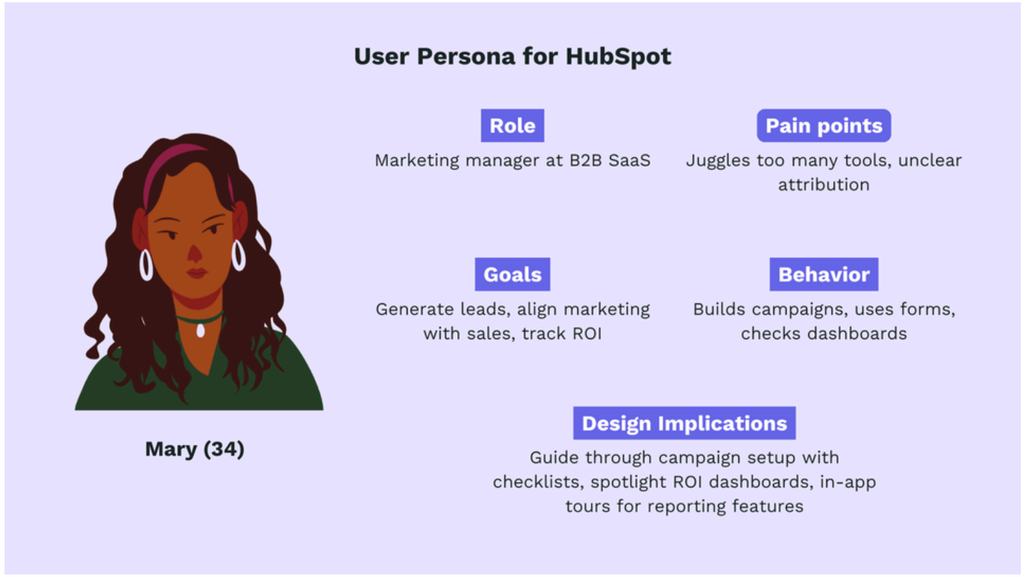
- “Anna, 29, busy professional. Shops via mobile on lunch breaks.”

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Example Persona-Driven Story

As Mary (a busy shopper), I want to save my cart for later so that I can check out quickly after work ...

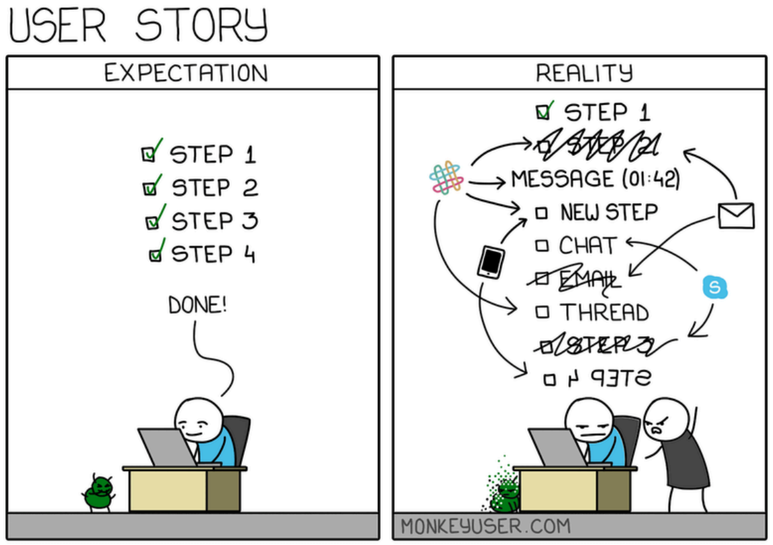
- Captures role (shopper) + persona context (busy schedule)
- Makes requirement more relatable and testable



User Stories Foundations : Beyond the Basics

Bad vs. Good Examples

- “As a user, I want to login so that I can use the system.”
- “As a user, I want to search.”



- “As a returning customer, I want to log in with one click so that I don’t waste time entering details again.”
- “As a student researching articles, I want to filter search results by publication date so that I can find the most recent studies.”

Thanks!

Questions?

